

DAVID SÁNCHEZ DE GROEVE

Technology Executive | Infrastructure, Operations & Enterprise Transformation

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Transferable Iqama | Immediately Available

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Technology Executive with 20+ years of experience leading mission-critical infrastructure, technology operations, digital transformation, and regulated platforms across Saudi Arabia and Europe. Directed the migration of critical transactional infrastructure supporting Saudi Arabia's *mada* payment rails into the KAFD Data Center with zero unplanned operational downtime. Previously scaled BNP Paribas' pan-European technology operations from 15 to 130+ software and systems engineers across 26 countries, managing an annual technology operations budget exceeding €1M, reducing major incidents by 35%, and sustaining 99.9% availability. Experienced in operational resilience, executive stakeholder management, SAMA and Saudi regulatory environments, vendor governance, cybersecurity controls, and enterprise technology transformation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Strategic Leadership:** Enterprise Technology Operations | Infrastructure Strategy | Digital Transformation | Team Scaling (15 – 130+)
 - **Mission-Critical Operations:** Data Center Migration | High-Availability Systems | Zero Unplanned Downtime | Business Continuity
 - **Regulatory, Risk & Governance:** SAMA Cybersecurity Framework | CST Requirements | Saudi PDPL | ITIL® Expert | Risk Controls
 - **Budget & Vendor Governance:** Annual Technology Operations Budget Management (€1M+) | SLA Negotiation | Vendor Governance
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SELECTED LEADERSHIP SCOPE

- **National Critical Infrastructure:** Technical operational resilience supporting *mada* payment rails within an ecosystem processing more than 8.9 billion annual transactions, with an annual value exceeding SAR 613.9 billion
- **Pan-European Team Scaling:** Led the centralization of pan-European technology operations across 26 countries into a unified Madrid-based operating model, managing 130+ software and systems engineers at BNP Paribas

- **Budget and Governance:** Managed €1M+ annual technology operations budgets, vendor SLAs, and executive governance reporting
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Director | Rommaana (InsurTech Platform)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Mar 2023 – Jun 2026

- Architected a secure, high-availability InsurTech platform from scratch tailored to the Saudi insurance sector, integrating multi-insurer API pipelines under strict delivery timelines.
- Engineered platform architecture and data pipelines with controls aligned with applicable **SAMA cybersecurity, CST, and Saudi Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL)** requirements.
- Embedded AI-augmented development frameworks into engineering workflows, accelerating MVP delivery and prototyping cycles while preserving regulatory compliance and data security.
- Delivered a production platform with a lean engineering structure, optimizing capital expenditure and establishing a reproducible AI-assisted delivery model.

Service Operations Manager | Saudi Payments (*mada* National Payment System)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Mar 2020 – Mar 2023

- Directed technical operational resilience and availability for Saudi Arabia's national *mada* payment rails, supporting an ecosystem processing more than 8.9 billion annual transactions with an annual value exceeding SAR 613.9 billion.
- Designed and executed the migration of critical transactional infrastructure from legacy SAMA facilities into the KAFD Data Center with **zero unplanned operational downtime**.
- Formulated risk isolation protocols and established executive KPI and resilience reporting frameworks used for senior governance, regulatory engagement, and Board-level reporting.
- Preserved national payment continuity, high-availability SLAs, and multi-bank transactional throughput throughout complex infrastructure transitions.

Head of Operations | BNP Paribas

Madrid, Spain | Sep 2015 – Mar 2020

- Led the centralization of pan-European technology operations across 26 countries into a unified, high-performing hub in Madrid.
- Scaled the engineering and operational organization from 15 to 130+ software and systems engineers while managing an annual technology operations budget exceeding €1,000,000.

- Reduced major production incidents by over 35% and maintained 99.9% application availability across corporate banking platforms by modernizing ITIL frameworks and vendor SLAs.
 - Streamlined operating costs (OPEX) through process consolidation, standardized incident management playbooks, and vendor contract negotiations.
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EARLIER PROFESSIONAL FOUNDATION

- **IT Team Lead** | International Air Transport Association (IATA), Madrid | *Feb 2009 – Sep 2015*
 - **Service Desk Technician** | Natixis, Madrid | *Mar 2007 – Dec 2008*
 - **Assistant Manager IT** | Banco Santander, Madrid | *Nov 2006 – Mar 2007*
 - **Service Desk Manager** | Grupo Zeta, Madrid | *Oct 1998 – Oct 2006*
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CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

- **ITIL® Expert** — IT Infrastructure Library
 - **Enterprise Project Management Program** — BNP Paribas Internal Certification
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LANGUAGES & WORK AUTHORIZATION

- **Languages:** English (Full Professional) | Spanish (Native/Bilingual) | French (Professional Working) | Arabic (Elementary)
- **Work Authorization:** Transferable Iqama | Immediately Available in Riyadh